



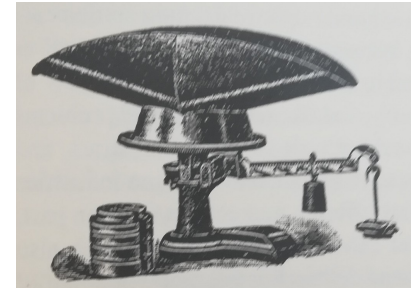
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CHAPTER XXIII

YEARS OF AGITATION

1880 – 1885

When the great colonizer-financier, Brigham Young died in 1877, many predicted the L.D.S. Church would fall apart. But his successor, John Taylor took over the reins with hardly a ripple. Although he had a different kind of personality from Brigham Young, this gifted Englishman soon demonstrated equal performance as an organizer and builder. His counselors, George Q. Cannon and Joseph F. Smith, were energetic, intelligent, talented men devoted to the ideals of Mormonism. No one would have dreamed when these men assumed this leadership that, within a decade, the Church would be passing through a trial even greater than that of Jackson County, Far West, and Nauvoo. Under federal pressure, the goal of the Kingdom would have to be drastically revised, or largely abandoned.¹

The prime economic problem of the Mormon settlements in the 1870's and early 1880's was keeping up with the increase in population. In every valley the continued flow of immigration and the natural increase in growth was overtaking the cultivated land, creating a serious situation, since the people depended greatly on agriculture. To combat this problem, projects to increase the supply of irrigable land were sponsored by ward, stake, and general church organizations. Patches of land were reclaimed from the desert and planted with hay, grain and vegetables. New settlements were

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founded outside of Utah in Colorado, Arizona, New Mexico, Idaho and Wyoming. All told, at least a hundred new Mormon settlements were founded outside of Utah between 1876 and 1879, as well as many new colonies being settled in Utah in remote areas. Many of these settlements were subsidized by the Church. Financial problems were attacked partly by the establishment of local industries, and partly by the redistribution of wealth and income. Home industries were promoted and tithing and fast offering money was used, in part, for employment on temples and other projects. The church also undertook a general cancellation of debts. For example, one-half of the debts owed to the Perpetual Emigration Company were canceled.

The dominant problem of the Church in the 1880's, however, was not unemployment and building the Kingdom, but preserving it from federal harassment and spoliation. While the Mormons were struggling with the problems of growth, powerful groups elsewhere in the nation were seeking to strengthen federal controls over their society. The issue of polygamy played a major role in this campaign, but Mormon collectivism in economics and politics was also under attack. The crusade which aimed to stamp out polygamy eventually put an end to most of the unique and non-capitalistic economic institutions for which Mormons were noted.²

There already had been several bills introduced into Congress aimed at the Mormons. Fortunately, these bills failed to pass. In 1862, Congress did pass an act which prohibited polygamy, disincorporated the church, and prohibited it from owning more than \$50,000 worth of property, other than buildings and properties used in connection with devotional purposes. Although this law was considered unconstitutional, the church attempted to make a superficial compliance with it by permitting only one civil marriage, calling the others "sealings," and placing properties acquired by the church in the hands of individual trustees. Taylor continued this policy of secretly placing certain church business properties in other people's names outside of the Church officials.³ A climax in the debate took place, November 30, 1879, when President John Taylor delivered a "red-hot" speech in the Provo Tabernacle that shocked public opinion. He was quoted in the *News Weekly* of December 31, as follows:

What shall we do? Shall we trust in God, or in the arm of flesh? Shall we give up our religion and our God and be governed by the practices that exist in the nation, which are contrary to the laws of God? All who are in favor of abiding by the laws of God hold up your right hands (the congregation voted unanimously). We find the same feeling throughout the Territory.

Taylor's speech caused a sensation, and the anti-Mormon press screamed; treason. Senator George F. Edmunds of Vermont boasted that he intended to write a law that would destroy polygamy.⁴

It was the hope of the L.D.S. people that these threats would not come to fruition, and life went on in southern Utah as normal as possible under the circumstances. The United States Census was taken in June of 1880. The records show that in Cedar City, Iron County on June 1, the following people lived in the household located at 100 East on High Street (Census taken by R. W. Heyborne):

<u>Henry Lunt</u>	Farmer	Age 55
Ellen, (Wife)	Keeping House	Age 50
Mary Ann (Wife)	Keeping House	Age 46
Annie (Wife)	Keeping House	Age 36
Sarah (Wife)	Keeping House	Age 21
Children:		
Henry, Jr.	Son of Mary Ann	Age 17
Jane	Dau of Annie	Age 16
Randle	Son of Mary Ann	Age 15
Jemima	Dau of Annie	Age 14
William	Son of Mary Ann	Age 13
Roselia	Dau of Annie	Age 12
Florence	Dau of Mary Ann	Age 10
Oscar	Son of Annie	Age 9
Violet	Dau of Mary Ann	Age 6
George	Son of Annie	Age 5
Alice	Dau of Mary Ann	Age 4

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Thomas	Son of Annie	Age 2
Edgerton	Son of Sarah Ann	Age 1
Ann Jackson	Servant, boarder from England	

The Census, taken on June 4 indicates the following people lived in the household at 100 West on Emigration Street where Henry Lunt's oldest two daughters, and their husbands and children, lived with the Jones family:

<u>Sage Jones</u>	Keeping House	Age 47
Lehi	Son	Age 25
Henrietta (Lunt) (Lehi's Wife)	Daughter-in-Law	Age 21
William	Son	Age 20
Uriah	Son (Twin)	Age 19
Sara Ann	Daughter (Twin)	Age 19
Thomas Willard	Grandson (Henrietta)	Age 1
Thomas Jediah	Son	Age 21
Ellen Eva (Lunt) (Jed's Wife)	Daughter-in-Law	Age 19
Lamoni	Grandson (Eva)	Age 1

On October 25, 1880, a daughter was born to Ann Gower and Henry Lunt. They gave her the name of Ellen Gower Lunt. Broughton, a son, was born to Sarah Ann and Henry Lunt on April 5, 1881. Three more grandchildren were born in the years of 1881 and 1882.

Mary Ann Lunt, Henry's second wife, was quite friendly with the Indians. She even understood their needs and dealt with them enough to learn their language and carry on a conversation with them. She received a Teachers Certificate which was signed by the Examining Board on February 2, 1881. It said, "We have found Mary Ann Wilson Lunt qualified to teach in a District School, and therefore issue this certificate to hold good for one year unless sooner recalled." That year, on August 6, 1881, she became a "Citizen of the United States of America," as written on the document sent to her from the District Court of the Second Judicial District of the Territory of Utah, County

of Beaver. It was written on the certificate that she was to "renounce forever all allegiance and fidelity to all and any foreign Prince, Potentate, State and Sovereignty whatsoever, and particularly to Victoria, Queen of Great Britain and Ireland and Empress of India." It was signed by James R. Wilkins, Clerk and William C. Mitchell, Deputy Clerk.⁵

Wilford Woodruff indicated in his journal that in October 1881, a party of church officials left Salt Lake for southern Utah. The group included President John Taylor, George Q. Cannon, Franklin D. Richards, John Henry Smith, F. M. Lyman, Wilford Woodruff and others. They stopped in several settlements along the way and met with the citizens. They spent the nights of November 1 and 2, 1881, at Beaver and reached Parowan on November 3. The following day they met with several brethren and gave counsel concerning the San Juan mission and held a meeting in the morning, after which they drove 18 miles to Cedar City. They held a meeting there at 6:30 in the evening. Wilford Woodruff spoke 30 minutes, Franklin D. Richards spoke 30 minutes, and President John Taylor spoke 70 Minutes.⁶

President Taylor and others of the group stayed at the Lunt Stage Stop on the night of November 4. Sarah Ann was helping the other wives run the hotel. The hotel was an exchange station for the drivers and horses of the stage coaches which came through. After enjoying a good home-cooked meal, the passengers were entertained by the Lunt family as they gathered in the large living room. The Lunt children sang and played instruments or gave comic readings.

Later, Edward, the son of Sarah, wrote a story about President Taylor that was related to him by his mother. He wrote that the incident occurred in Cedar City when President John Taylor had remained at the Lunt home in order to rest before the evening session of conference. He had been lying down in his room and had asked Sarah Ann to awaken him if he overslept. It hadn't been very long until he walked into the kitchen and told her about a dream that he had just had. He said that he saw Salt Lake City become a great and beautiful city with homes covering the city. The streets were of cement. The people had become wealthy and had become indifferent to the counsel of the authorities of the Church and were more

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interested in the accumulation of wealth than they were in living their religion. People were fighting among themselves, until it became so serious that the entire Church records were taken across the Colorado River to keep them safe. President Taylor said to her, "If you are alive at that time, be sure that you are not far behind the records." Not only Salt Lake City, but other cities will be destroyed and in the east, in Jackson County, Missouri, civilization will become extinct. All means of transportation will be destroyed and the only means of travel will be on foot. The manufacturing of all kinds will be destroyed. Be sure when you see these things come, see that you have buttons, needles and things to work with in leather to make yourself clothing, thread and cloth as far as possible, because all tools of every kind will be destroyed. But the Lord will bless those who stay with the authorities and they shall not be destroyed. They will travel south and will finally form a circle something like a horseshoe before they return to Jackson County, Missouri. Those who will be privileged to help build Jackson County will be those who are willing and glad to obey the counsel and advice of the authorities placed over them. The Saints will be taxed so heavily that they will cry to the Lord, day and night for 'deliverance.' He said that we would be few in numbers and would assist the Lamanites in building the New Jerusalem in Jackson County. After this he said, "Sister Lunt, see that you always listen to and obey the advice of the authorities, and stay with them." This has been called "The Horseshoe Prophecy," and, in a letter to the Stake Presidents of the L.D.S. Church dated Mar. 30, 1870, Pres. Joseph F. Smith renounced it because the Church had no knowledge of it. The Lunt family had a record of this incident and, the fact that the authorities were in Cedar City at that time, makes the story plausible.

In the early part of 1882 the Saints began to feel the effects of the agitation against them concerning their beliefs, and Congress was beset by the enemies of the Church who urged the government to pass drastic measures against the Mormons. The President of the L.D.S. Church and the twelve Apostles made special efforts to get the facts before the country, and before the Congress. The spirit of anti-Mormonism had worked itself into a state of frenzy in all parts of the country. On Feb. 15, 1882, Wilford Woodruff wrote the following:

There has never been a time since the organization of this Church when such a universal howl was raised against us. The whole land is flooded with lies against the people of God. The government seems determined on the destruction of the faithful Latter-day Saints.

The month of March 1882, was an important landmark in the history of the Mormon people. What has been properly labeled, "the Crusade," dates from that period. On the 14th of March 1882, the Edmunds Bill passed the House of Representatives by a vote of 190 to 42, and ten days later the Bill became a law. This law took away the right to vote or to hold public office from all who lived the polygamous relationship, and a mere belief in the doctrine of plural marriage was sufficient to bar an individual from jury service. The Edmunds Act virtually deprived Utah of those rights of self-government which had become a definite factor in the government of territories.⁸ Wilford Woodruff wrote the following in regards to this:

It is entirely a breach of the Constitution of the United States; condemns men before trial or conviction by court or jury; takes away the right of trial by a jury of their peers; makes an ex post facto law and a bill of attainder; takes away from the Latter-day Saints, because of their religious convictions, the franchise; and deprives them from sitting on juries because of their opinions; but if the nation can stand it, we can. It is taking a stand against God, against Christ and His Kingdom, and against His people.

During those hectic years, the President of the United States, Rutherford Hayes, proposed that all potential violators of the polygamy act be arrested and placed in prison before they had an opportunity to violate the law. The Mormons felt humiliated and Congress had disgraced the Constitution. President Taylor said:

While the excitement lasts, it is useless to reason

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with the politicians in Congress. When the excitement ends, we can talk to them. We do not wish to place ourselves in a state of antagonism, nor act defiantly toward this Government. We will fulfill the letter, so far as practicable, of that unjust, inhuman, oppressive and unconstitutional law. But, we cannot sacrifice every principle of human right. We are not craven serfs, and have not learned to lick the feet of oppressors, nor to bow in base submission of unreasonable clamor. We will contend, inch by inch, legally and constitutionally, for our rights as American citizens.⁹

Although the Utah Commission began to function within a few months after the passage of the 1882 law, and although federal officials began immediately to gather evidence against the Latter-day Saints, particularly their leaders, there was widespread belief that the Edmunds Act was unconstitutional. There were 1,004 convictions for unlawful cohabitation under this bill between 1884 and 1893, and another 31 for polygamy, but these hardly measure the magnitude of the effect of the Act upon Mormon society.¹⁰ However, the Edmunds Act took some time to implement and the people of Utah didn't feel the real effects of it for several years.

Two more children were born into the Lunt family in 1883. The tenth and last child of Ann Gower and Henry Lunt, Rachel Ann Lunt, was born February 19, 1883. Sarah Ann's third child, Parley L. Lunt, was born at Johnson Springs (Rush Lake ranch, a few miles north of Enoch) on February 22, the same year. He was Henry's twenty-first child. Two more Lunt grandchildren were born in 1883.

The fifty-third annual conference of the L.D.S. Church was held in Salt Lake in April 1883. The proceedings of that conference were published in the May 28, 1883-edition of the *Millennial Star*, a Church magazine which sold for the price of one penny per copy. In the assembly at 2:00 p.m. on April 8, after the opening proceedings, a list of the names of missionaries was read to the congregation to be sustained. Some were called to Great Britain, Scandinavia, Sandwich

Islands, and to various places in the United States. President George Q. Cannon, Counselor to John Taylor, said that besides the names sustained as missionaries, it should be understood that the Twelve Apostles are standing missionaries and should be sustained as such, the same as those who are presented to the conference. He then read a list of names of men that had been appointed to labor as missionaries under the direction of the Twelve Apostles. They, too, were sustained. Among these was Henry Lunt, the only local missionary called from Cedar City. He performed in this capacity in Cedar City for several years before being called on a mission to England.

Other information that appeared in that issue of the *Millennial Star* concerned resolutions made by the government during the late session of the Missouri Legislature. One of these resolutions contained instructions that, "the Senators and Representatives in Congress were to use their influence to procure the withdrawal of the army from the Territories into the Union, and for the enfranchisement [liberate and admit to citizenship] of the Indians and Mormons." The resolution pointed out that, if the United States armies were withdrawn, it would save the government seven million dollars annually, "which now goes directly into the pockets of the most corrupt ring that has yet sprung from the prolific and ever-fruitful quiver of the Republican Party."¹¹

Henry Lunt was called by President Taylor to, once again, hold the position of Bishop of the Cedar Ward on May 5, 1884, upon the release of C. J. Arthur. Henry chose Francis Webster and Robert Heyborne as his Counselors. During his tenure as bishop, Henry sent several men from his ward, each year, on missions, either to foreign countries or somewhere in the United States. As bishop, he wrote a letter to President D. H. Wells which was published in the *Millennial Star*. The following are excerpts from the letter:

Dear Brother: A few days ago, I had the pleasure of greeting my friend and fellow laborer, Elder C. J. Arthur, who has just returned from a successful mission in England of two years duration.

I find that quite a change has come over affairs since my departure from my native land, and where

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baptisms were of frequent occurrence in those days, I now understand that our brethren who are laboring as missionaries may justly be termed 'gleaners,' going forth, as it were, at the eleventh hour and gathering grapes when the 'vintage is o'er.'

While the spirit of indifference is manifest by a large majority of the people of the world, we find that Satan is stirring up the hearts of some of the people who have been permitted to gather to the bosom of the Church and take part in reclaiming the desert and making the waste places smooth. However, I am pleased to say that these cases are of rare occurrence and, while we sadly deplore their course, we feel that such actions have a tendency to brighten up those who are striving to be faithful. I can see a bright day for the faithful.

One thing is apparent, the present crusade which is waged against us, is not the result of our domestic affairs. It is true that polygamy is made the 'hobby-horse,' but the fact is, the unity of our people is what is disturbing the religious world, and, as was said in former days, is reiterated today: 'If we let these people alone, they will take away our place and nation.' Our motto is, 'Peace on earth and goodwill to all,' and an improvement of the social condition, while the reverse is the case with our would be reformers.

The season that has just closed has been exceedingly fruitful. We have enjoyed beautiful rains during the spring and summer months, and seasonable showers during the fall, which has been one of the most favorable for outdoor work that could be desired. Times are unusually dull here and money exceedingly scarce; the avenue for cash having measurably closed; I refer to the mining camps located close by. Things at Silver Reef and Frisco, which are the principal mining camps in the southern part of the

the principal mining camps in the southern part of the Territory, are almost at a standstill, which creates somewhat of a money panic amongst us. Grain is unusually cheap; wheat, one dollar ten cents per 100 lbs; flour, from two dollars to two dollars fifty cents; potatoes, from thirty-five to forty cents per bushel; beef, from four to ten cents per pound; labor, from one dollar to one dollar fifty cents per day; so while you observe that cash is scarce, the where-with-al to live and be comfortable is within the reach of all.

Please remember me kindly to the brethren in the Office, with best wishes from your fellow laborer, Henry Lunt.¹²

The Church officials decided to build a temple in Logan, Utah, and it was dedicated in 1884. The following entry was written in a journal by Joel H. Martineau, a citizen of Logan:

On May 17, 1884, the temple [Logan] was dedicated. Seven years were spent in its construction. President John Taylor conducted the dedication services. Among the visitors who lived at our house were: Lucy B. Young and daughters, Susan Young Gates and Rhoda Mable Young McCallisters. Also, Patriarch Henry Lunt of Cedar City, an old friend of Father's, who gave me a Patriarchal Blessing [while he was staying there].

The settlers in Cedar City were having many problems with their cattle being stolen. On September 27, 1884, they formed the Live-stock Protection Association and a meeting of the principle stock owners was held on October 4. They drew up an agreement in which they stated that this association was organized for the purpose of mutual protection of the stock interest of Cedar City against the operations of "cattle thieves and other unprincipled characters, and to form and adopt our agreement for the regulation of said associa-

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was Henry Lunt. They agreed to pay money to the Association, according to the number of cattle and horses they owned, to defray the expenses of guarding the livestock and prosecuting the thieves.¹³

In 1885 the Cedar City Tabernacle was finished. The excavation for this building was done in 1872, but the building was not started for five years, during which time all available craftsmen worked on the St. George Temple. During this time water was frequently turned into the hole to settle the ground. In 1877, many brick and stone masons and carpenters donated their time to the erection of this beautiful building. Lumber for the building was taken from nearby mountains and milled in local sawmills and the shingles and bricks were also locally made. The main building was 72 by 42 ½ feet. The height of the tower was 110 feet, and there was a town clock in the steeple.

On July 21, 1885, a son was born in Nephi, Utah to Sarah and Henry Lunt. This was the home of Sarah's parents. They named the child Edward Lunt. By this time Jane Gower Lunt, Henry W. Lunt, and Randle W. Lunt were married and, by the end of 1886, Henry had eleven grandchildren in addition to his twenty-two children.

1. Leonard J. Arrington, *Great Basin Kingdom*, (Lincoln, Nebraska: University of Nebraska Press, 1958), p. 353.
2. *Ibid.*, p. 356.
3. *Ibid.*, p. 356.
4. Wayne Stout, *The Mighty John Taylor*, S.U.U. Special Collections, Cedar City, Ut.
5. James R. Wilkins, "Certificate of Citizenship," Beaver County Court House, Beaver, Utah.
6. Wilford Woodruff, *Wilford Woodruff Journal*, Entry of November 4, 1881, S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah, p. 63.
7. Edward Lunt, "Lunt Family File," signed by Edward Lunt Jan. 9, 1952, Mesa Arizona.
8. William E. Berrett, *The Restored Church*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Deseret Book Publishing Co., 1969), p. 318.
9. Wayne Scott, *op. cit.*
10. Leonard J. Arrington, *op. cit.*, p. 359.
11. *Millennial Star*, 22 Vol. XIV, May 28, 1883, Cedar City Library.
12. *Ibid.*, January 1886, Letter written, November 27, 1885. p. 27. (L.D.S. Institute, Cedar City, Utah.)
13. Iron County Clerk, "Livestock Agreement," dated October 4, 1884, William R. Palmer Collection, S.U.U. Library, Cedar City, Utah.